

FFXIV Character Viewer - Technical Documentation

Cascade AI

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1 Overview

The FFXIV Character Viewer is a web application that allows users to search for and view character information from Final Fantasy XIV's Lodestone website. This document provides a detailed explanation of how the application works, including example URLs and the data flow process.

2 System Architecture

The application consists of three main components:

1. Frontend (React/JavaScript)
2. Local Proxy Server (Node.js/Express)
3. FFXIV Lodestone (External Data Source)

3 Search Process

3.1 Step 1: User Input

When a user searches for a character (e.g., "Mommy Thames" on Aether), the following process occurs:

- a) User enters the character name: "Mommy Thames"
- b) User selects or enters the Data Center: "Aether"
- c) The search form submits these parameters to our local API

3.2 Step 2: Local Proxy Server

The server constructs a Lodestone URL with the following format:

```
1 https://na.finalfantasyxiv.com/lodestone/character/?q=Mommy%20
   Thames&worldname=_region_2&classjob=&race_tribe=&blog_lang=ja&
   blog_lang=en&blog_lang=de&blog_lang=fr&order=
```

Parameters explained:

- q=Mommy%20Thames - The character name (URL encoded)
- worldname=_region_2 - North American data centers
- blog_lang parameters - Include results in all languages

3.3 Step 3: Request Headers

The server adds browser-like headers to avoid being blocked:

```
1 headers = {
2   'User-Agent': 'Mozilla/5.0 (Windows NT 10.0; Win64; x64) ...',
3   'Accept': 'text/html,application/xhtml+xml,...',
4   'Accept-Language': 'en-US,en;q=0.9',
5   'Referer': 'https://na.finalfantasyxiv.com/lodestone/'
6 }
```

3.4 Step 4: HTML Parsing

When the Lodestone responds, the application:

- a) Receives the HTML content
- b) Uses DOMParser to parse the HTML
- c) Looks for character entries using selectors:

```
1 .ldst__window .character-list__list
2 .ldst__contents .character-list__list
3 .character-list__list
4 #character
5
```

4 Character Details Process

4.1 Step 1: Character Selection

When a user selects a character, the application:

- a) Extracts the character ID from their URL
- b) Constructs a character details URL:

```
1 https://na.finalfantasyxiv.com/lodestone/character/[ID]/
2
```

4.2 Step 2: Data Extraction

The application extracts:

- Character name (`.frame__chara__name`)
- Server name (`.frame__chara__world`)
- Portrait image (`.frame__chara__face img`)
- Biography (`.character__selfintroduction`)
- Job levels (`.character__level__list li`)

5 Example URLs

5.1 Search URL

For searching "Mommy Thames" on Aether:

```
1 https://na.finalfantasyxiv.com/lodestone/character/?q=Mommy%20
  Thames&worldname=_region_2&classjob=&race_tribe=&blog_lang=ja&
  blog_lang=en&blog_lang=de&blog_lang=fr&order=
```

5.2 Character Details URL

For viewing a specific character (example ID: 12345678):

```
1 https://na.finalfantasyxiv.com/lodestone/character/12345678/
```

6 Error Handling

The application includes several error handling mechanisms:

1. Network request errors
2. HTML parsing errors
3. Missing data handling
4. Invalid response handling

Each error is logged to the console with detailed information to help with debugging.